

The Commercial Cleaning Prospecting Starter Kit

25 buying triggers, a working tracker, and three emails that use them

Free. No catch, and nothing in here stops halfway.

Why triggers

Most commercial buildings already have a cleaner. They are not unhappy enough to go looking, and they will not switch because your email was better written than the last one.

They switch when something changes. They move, they open a second site, a new management company takes over, someone gets hired whose job includes vendors, a contract goes out to bid.

Those moments are public. Permits, business listings, job postings, procurement portals, property records. Nobody hides them, and almost nobody in this industry looks for them.

That is the whole idea. Not better copy — better timing.

The one rule

A trigger is an event, not a conclusion.

You saw a permit filed. You did not see their cleaning contract.

So you may write *"I noticed you moved to Commerce Street."* You may not write *"you probably need a new cleaner."*

Three reasons, in ascending order of importance. It's checkable, so it survives someone asking how you found them. It keeps you clear of email rules that take a dim view of misleading messages. And **buyers can tell**. Everyone guessing at them sounds identical. Someone who states a fact and makes a conditional offer sounds like a person who did the work.

Two things every trigger needs: a **source** (where you saw it) and a **date** (when it happened, not when you found it). Without both, don't use it.

The 25 triggers

Grouped by how much they're worth. Within each group, the ones nearer the top are usually easier to find.

Strong — a building may genuinely be in the market

1. Janitorial contract out to bid

Where: state, county and school-district procurement portals. Most publish openly and many send email alerts.

Fresh for: until the deadline — check it first. **Why almost nobody uses this:** it looks like paperwork. It is the only trigger on this list where the building has *told you in writing* that it is buying.

2. New facility or first occupancy

Where: occupancy and tenant-improvement permits on your county or city portal. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Why it's the best one on this list:** there is no incumbent to displace. It's a first purchase, not a switch.

3. New location opened

A second or additional site under a brand that already exists. **Where:** a new Google Business listing under an existing name · "now open" notices · local press. **Fresh for:** 120 days.

4. Move or relocation

Where: address change on their Google listing · "we've moved" notices · business-journal "on the move" columns. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Why it lands:** they're buying everything at once and want it off the list.

5. New commercial lease signed

A listing flips from available to leased. **Where:** commercial property listing sites. Check the same handful weekly and note what changed. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Note:** often 30–60 days ahead of the occupancy permit, so you're early.

6. Property management change

A management company takes on a building. **Where:** portfolio pages on management company sites · listing sites · signage you notice while driving. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Why it's worth the most per conversation:** new managers review inherited vendors, and one relationship can cover several buildings.

7. Building sold or changed owner

Where: county property records. Searchable in most counties. **Fresh for:** 120 days. **Why:** new owners review operating costs, and cleaning is an easy line to look at.

8. Competitor cleaning company closing or sold

Their accounts need a vendor. **Where:** a Google listing going "permanently closed" · a business-for-sale listing · local talk. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Handle carefully:** approach the *buildings*, not the competitor's staff, and never mention the competitor by name.

Medium — something is happening, and it may include cleaning

9. Facilities or operations hiring

Where: Indeed and LinkedIn — "Facilities Manager", "Office Manager", "Operations Manager". **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Two-edged:** they may review vendors, or be too new to change anything for six months.

10. Renovation or reopening

Where: renovation permits · reopening announcements · temporary closure on their listing. **Fresh for:** 60 days.

Note: post-construction cleaning is a separate, usually larger, one-off job.

11. Tenant improvement for an existing tenant

Not a new occupancy — an existing business rebuilding its space. **Where:** TI permits at an address that already has a business. **Fresh for:** 60 days.

12. Suite expansion in the same building

They took the unit next door. **Where:** listing changes · updated square footage · a second suite number appearing. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Why it's easy to win:** their current cleaner is priced for the old footprint.

13. New business license issued

Where: city or county business-license records. Many publish a searchable list. **Fresh for:** 120 days.

14. Sign permit filed

A new sign usually means a new tenant or a rebrand. **Where:** the same permit portal as occupancy. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Underrated:** cheap to check, and often the earliest public signal there is.

15. Acquisition

Where: local business journals · press releases · state registries. **Fresh for:** 120 days. **Note:** consolidation goes both ways. You might win or lose.

16. New franchise location announced

Where: the brand's locations page · franchise development pages · permits. **Fresh for:** 120 days. **Check first:** whether the brand contracts cleaning centrally. Many do.

17. New provider or partner joining a practice

Where: staff pages on medical and dental sites · local announcements. **Fresh for:** 90 days. **Why:** more chairs, more rooms in use, more cleaning.

18. Post-construction completion

Final inspection passed on a commercial build. **Where:** the permit portal, filtered to finalized permits. **Fresh for:** 60 days.

19. Public-sector RFP for related services

Grounds, maintenance or facilities work going out to bid at a site. **Where:** the same procurement portals as trigger 6. **Fresh for:** until the deadline. **Why:** a site reviewing one vendor category often reviews others.

Weak — activity, not necessarily a cleaning need

Use these to break a tie between two accounts that already have a stronger trigger, or as filler when your list is thin.

20. Headcount growth · 21. Funding or a news mention · 22. Business anniversary or milestone

A company that raised money has more money. It does not have a dirtier office.

23. Reopening after an extended closure

Where: Google listing status changing back to open.

24. Seasonal calendar

Schools before term and before the summer break. Childcare the same. Not an event, but a real window, and the only trigger here you can plan a year ahead.

25. Review mentions cleaning

A public review mentioning dirt or restrooms.

This feels like the strongest trigger on the page. It isn't, and the reason matters.

It does not tell you the business controls the cleaning contract, that the reviewer was an employee rather than a customer, that the problem is current, or that anyone is looking. It's an inference about dissatisfaction, not an observation of a buying window.

Never quote it to a prospect. It reads as surveillance, and it asserts something about their vendor you can't support.

Three emails

Four beats, in this order: **what you observed** → **what you do** → **a conditional offer** → **an easy question**. Under 100 words. Plain text. Replace everything in [brackets].

New location or occupancy

Subject: the new [street] office

Hi [First name] – I saw [company] opened at [street] last month. Congratulations.

We do recurring commercial cleaning around [area].

If cleaning for the new space is still being arranged, I'd be glad to walk it and put a scope and price together.

Would Tuesday or Thursday suit for fifteen minutes?

– [Your name], [Your company]

Move or relocation

Subject: your move to [street]

Hi [First name] – noticed [company] moved into [street] recently.

We handle nightly and weekly cleaning for offices around [area].

A move means sorting out a lot of vendors at once. If cleaning is still on that list, I can walk the space and have a scoped proposal to you in two days.

Would a quick call this week help?

Facilities hire

Subject: saw the facilities role

Hi [First name] – saw [company] is hiring a facilities manager.

We provide recurring commercial cleaning around [area]. When facilities becomes someone's actual job, vendor arrangements usually get reviewed at some point.

No rush on my side. If it'd be useful to have a scoped quote on file for when that happens, I'm glad to walk the space.

Worth a short call?

Why "no rush on my side" is in the third one: that trigger is real but slow. Copy that pretends it's urgent reads as false, and this audience has seen a lot of false urgency.

Sending rules

Three emails to one account, then stop. A fourth doesn't win the contract and costs you the chance to come back when something actually changes.

Every email needs your business name, a real postal address, and a way to opt out. Honour any opt-out immediately and permanently.

Never claim a prospect has no cleaner, is unhappy, or is shopping.

Don't start at full volume from a new mailbox — ramp over a few weeks, and don't send from the domain your customers already email you at.

The tracker

The spreadsheet with this kit has one tab and room for twenty accounts. Type in the left-hand columns; the score and band calculate themselves.

How to use it, in five minutes:

1. Pick **one** building type and **one** suburb. Broad searches return the same names everyone else is already calling.
2. Add twenty accounts. Google Maps is the easiest source.
3. Apply the seven filters listed on the tab. Expect to delete most of them — if you keep all twenty, you weren't strict enough.
4. Score what survives. **Work 13+ first. Below 7, stop.**
5. For the top handful, find the trigger. Log the exact observation, where you saw it, and the date.
6. Send the matching email above.

Twenty well-chosen accounts beat four hundred bought ones. You can research twenty properly. You can't research four hundred, so you'd email them all the same thing — which is what everyone else does, and why it doesn't work.

When this tab stops being enough

One tab and twenty rows is right for a first list. You'll know when it isn't.

It happens when you're doing this weekly rather than once — when you want to see which accounts you contacted three weeks ago and never followed up, which triggers have gone stale, which campaign a reply came from, and whether this month was better than last. None of that fits in one tab, and working around it with coloured rows and a second sheet is how people quietly stop doing it at all.

That's the honest reason the full version exists. Not more rows — stages, follow-up flags, campaign tracking, a pipeline view and a weekly scoreboard.

What this kit doesn't cover

It gets you from nothing to a first list and a first conversation. That's a real slice and it works on its own.

What it doesn't include is the rest of the system: the full scoring model, the claim table for what each trigger lets you say, the eleven-tab tracker with stages and follow-up flags, reply handling, the walkthrough checklist, how to price a job two ways, the proposal structure, and the weekly scoreboard.

That's the **Commercial Cleaning Client Acquisition OS**, and it exists if you want it. But run this first. If twenty accounts and three emails don't produce a conversation, a bigger system won't fix that — and you'll have found out for free.